

July 7, 2025

Hon. Michelle L. Phillips
Secretary
New York Public Service Commission
3 Empire State Plaza
Albany, NY 12223-1350

RE: Case 18-E-0138: Proceeding on Motion of the Commission Regarding Electric Vehicle Supply Equipment and Infrastructure

**Comments of the Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC)
on Joint Utilities' Petition to Extend the Managed Charging Programs**

I. Introduction

The Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC) is a 501(c)(6) membership-based trade association committed to advancing vehicle-grid integration (VGI) through policy development, education, outreach, and research. VGIC supports the transition to decarbonized transportation and electric sectors by ensuring the value from flexible EV charging and discharging is recognized and compensated in support of a more reliable, affordable, and efficient electric grid. VGIC appreciates the opportunity to provide comments to the Public Service Commission (PSC) in response to the *Joint Utilities' Petition to Extend the Managed Charging Programs*, filed on April 9, 2025. In the below comments, VGIC expresses its support for the petition, and provides additional overarching feedback on no-regrets steps to better leverage EVs for the benefit of ratepayers and New York's broader state policy goals. Our comments are organized as follows:

- General support for the Joint Utilities' petition
- The need to include consideration of technological advancements in managed charging, including active managed charging and bidirectional charging systems, within the process to reauthorize the Programs beyond 2026

II. VGIC Supports the Joint Utilities' Request to Continue the Existing Program Implementation.

Overall, VGIC is encouraged by the high participation numbers in the utilities' managed charging programs. Experimenting with different program structures has helped generate lessons

learned and best practices to help inform New York’s transportation electrification strategy going forward. We believe the Joint Utilities’ request to reauthorize the existing managed charging programs and the specific requested budget transfer for O&R’s program are reasonable, no-regrets actions the Commission should take to avoid disruption to program enrollment. Program continuity is critical to ensuring the success of these programs.

III. VGIC Supports the Joint Utilities’ Request to Initiate a Managed Charging Program Reauthorization Process After New MCIPs Are Filed by January 30, 2026, But Recommends Scoping Consideration of Key Technological Advancements.

In its petition, the Joint Utilities recommend that the Commission initiate a process to reauthorize the Programs in 2026. VGIC strongly supports this recommendation, but offers a critical enhancement to ensure the programs are well aligned with the state of the industry, available technology, customer interests, and New York’s state goals: VGIC urges the Commission to scope active managed charging and bidirectional charging systems into the consideration of the Programs in 2026.

The utilities’ Programs are largely focused on passive managed charging, rather than active managed charging. While participation is encouraging, the Joint Utilities’ own data show that off-peak charging performance varies widely from 62 percent at Con Edison to 93 percent at Central Hudson.¹ In peer programs that use active managed-charging, off-peak shares are often at 90 percent or higher.² These results suggest New York is leaving significant load-shifting value on the table and would benefit from a measured expansion of active managed-charging functionality as part of the forthcoming re-authorization. **As a result, VGIC respectfully urges the Commission to ensure active managed charging is a focal point for the consideration of the Programs in 2026 and, if possible, provide related guidance to the Joint Utilities *prior* to the January 30, 2026 MCIP filings.**

The July 14, 2022 Commission *Order Approving Managed Charging Programs with Modifications* was primarily focused on unidirectional smart charging technologies. The focus on unidirectional charging was reasonable at the time, given the lack of bidirectional charging solutions available to residential customers. However, over the past three years, the industry has made substantial steps forward in commercializing, marketing, and installing bidirectional charging equipment. Currently, bidirectional charging equipment is advertised to customers of the Ford F-150 Lightning Electric, nearly every GM electric vehicle, the Tesla Cybertruck, the Kia EV9, and the Nissan LEAF. Additional product announcements have been made by

¹ Case 18-E-0138. Petition of the Joint Utilities to Extend Residential Managed Charging Programs. Page 8.

² <https://www.ev.energy/blog/dynamic-pricing-outperforms-time-of-use-in-california-ev-charging-pilot-with-98-energy-delivered-off-peak>

Volkswagen, Volvo, Hyundai, Polestar, BMW, Mercedes-Benz, Stellantis, and Rivian. On the charging manufacturer side, products from Ford/Sunrun, GM, Wallbox, dcbe, Emporia, ChargePoint, Enphase, SolarEdge, and Autel have either been released or announced.

Meanwhile, the grid benefits that EVs can provide via unidirectional managed charging programs could be substantially augmented through strategic implementation of bidirectional charging systems. Bidirectional charging can serve as a valuable grid resource that provides generation capacity in critical downstate areas (such as NYISO zones J and K) where new transmission and generation is difficult to site. As EV adoption continues to increase in the Joint Utilities' service territory, bidirectional charging could become a critical tool to aid with summer reliability needs as New York seeks to phase out fossil generation in these constrained areas. Additionally, bidirectional capability unlocks new value propositions to customers, such as backup power in the event of an outage, that managed charging alone cannot provide.

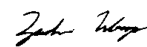
The Programs currently implemented do not adequately address these possibilities. **With this in mind, VGIC strongly recommends that the Commission explicitly scope consideration of bidirectional charging systems into a forthcoming reauthorization process and, if possible, provide related guidance to the Joint Utilities *prior* to the January 30, 2026 MCIP filings.** Notably, VGIC has been an active participant in the recent development of bidirectional charging programs in Massachusetts, California, and Maryland, and would be eager to share lessons learned from these experiences to ensure New York maintains its position as an innovative, future-oriented state.

IV. Conclusion

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to provide these comments and looks forward to working with the Joint Utilities, the Commission, Department of Public Service staff, and other stakeholders to ensure the success of New York's transportation electrification and grid decarbonization efforts.

Respectfully submitted,

Zach Woogen



Executive Director

Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC)